

Mike Speight – Senior User Interface developer and User Experience Architect/Consultant

Contact:

Email: mike@mike-speight.co.uk (Preferred method of contact)
Mobile: 07773 964633
Portfolio: <http://www.mike-speight.co.uk>

About Me:

Name: Mike Speight
Nationality: English
Location: Lingfield, Surrey
Interested in: Contract work only
Availability: Immediately available

I am a senior Front End/UI developer. Who has built several Front Ends to leading sites over many years... I am passionate about building great user interfaces with the best user experience. Using the latest web technologies.

I gained a lot of experience working in a consultancy/agency environment. So I'm comfortable with the pressures and demands of these types of work environments.

As a result of working in these roles, I have developed Interest and skills in the following areas:

HTML. Probably the basic and most important skill of the Front-End developer is the ability to analyse page designs and produce, modular, flexible, semantically correct and reusable HTML markup, that can adapt to a range of different interfaces or devices. This is a skill I have developed over quite a few years, producing high-end interfaces.

CSS. My CSS skills have evolved in parallel with the technology over the years. From the early days of table-based layouts and inline CSS. To the present day. That makes use of new layout techniques, like Flexbox and Grid. I can also full accustomed to using the latest in CSS technology, such as custom properties (CSS variables), pseudo-classes, new screen units of measurement and concepts such as the:root element and the shadow dom. I am fully conversant in the use of media queries and more recently container queries.

Preprocessors. I have become proficient in recent years, in both SASS and LESS. these technologies allow me to not only write CSS easier. But also to maintain, update and organise the resulting CSS in unique ways. for example through the use of included files, that split CSS into functional sections like variables, mixins and code.

JavaScript. I have been coding JavaScript since the late nineties. Before that, I was programming in C. I have seen quite a few libraries/frameworks in that time and have used many. I have exposure to some of the latest technologies like React, Angular, Vue and Typescript. I try to keep up with the latest trends and improvements. I have been following the changes to JavaScript itself i.e. ES6. I am comfortable working with JavaScript.

Front End Stack. I can use various tools, such as task runners like Gulp and Grunt. Along with Node and NPM. To build a front End Stack that automates and manages many front-end tasks.

Along with package management tools, to install, update and manage project dependencies.

Version Control. I have installed and managed version control systems on many projects. GIT is the main VCS I have worked with, via GitHub and my own repositories. I have experience with other VCSs too.

Content Management Systems. I have worked with many CMS' over the years, including; WordPress, Drupal, AEM, Sitecore etc. And many others.

Server Technologies. I am not aligned with any particular server technology, as I have worked with many. Microsoft and open source technologies. But I spent quite a bit of time working on Microsoft platforms in my time with Conchango/EMC Consulting.

UX, I have over the years had the opportunity to develop my skills in the area of User Experience. Working on many small teams or teams where there has been no UE Architect or design resource available. It has fallen to me, to take on these roles and help the team in these areas. In so doing I have developed these skills.

Agile. I have spent a lot of time with Agile and particularly SCRUM, since 2004. I have taken several Agile training courses. and became a certified Scrum Master in 2007. I have been working with it ever since.

Areas of focus. I try and keep up with new technologies to improve my base skill set and keep up with industry trends. Areas I am particularly in are. SEO/Search Engine Optimisation, website optimisation, and analytics. To maintain and develop a holistic web development skill set.

Self-Employment – Contracting:

Digital Direction Consultants Limited

October 2022: Front-End Web Developer and UI /UX Architect/Designer.

Have been working Web Developer and Consultant, working exclusively for private SME clients. This has involved offering consultancy services in several areas, from what and how to improve their web offerings. To design and build. These include creating WordPress sites from the ground up, to More bespoke solutions. I am currently working on a selection of websites and web applications for my clients using, React, Vue, Next and TypeScript. Technologies used include: HTML5, CSS3, SASS, JavaScript, TypeScript, React JS, Node JS, Vue.js, WordPress, Bootstrap, Material Design, Gulp, and Bower.

H&M - <https://hmgroup.com>

Jan 2022 October 2022: Scrum Master/Front-End developer.

I was engaged as a joint Scrum Master and Front End developer for H&M's Search Engine Optimisation, Centre of Excellence. Where I was tasked with, coaching a distributed team between Stockholm and India, to work closer to the Scrum framework, which had been followed quite loosely previously. And to implement the ceremonies in a more traditional manner. As part of the front-end team, I was also tasked with implementing new pages and improving existing pages, PLPs and PDPs, from a front-end perspective. Technologies used include: HTML5, CSS3, SASS, JavaScript, Hybris, React JS, TypeScript, Node JS, Web components, Shadow DOM, Gulp, and Bower.

Thales UK - <https://www.thalesgroup.com>

March 2021 December 2021: User Interface/User Experience Designer Developer.

My role a Thales was to provide Front End/UX expertise to their TIRIS Smart Maintenance Web Application for the Transport/Railway Industry, the application is used by railway companies in many countries across the world. In particular, I was tasked with developing new features, upgrading and supporting existing features bug fixing and making general improvements to the product. <https://www.thalesgroup.com/en/countries/europe/united-kingdom>. Technologies used include: HTML5, CSS3, SASS, JavaScript, jQuery, Polymer JS, Node JS, Web components, Shadow DOM, Gulp, Bower, Vaadin, Web Components

Mtivity - <https://www.mtivity.com>

July 2019 – July 2020 Lead User Interface/User Experience Developer/Designer.

I was engaged by this internationally based company, to work remotely with their Marketing Acceleration Platform, to augment and generally improve the existing UI and to develop the UI/UX for new modules to be included in the platform, using various APIs. These include a module to add the facility for the user to visually see the details in their accounts via a dashboard that allows the inclusion of many types of charts, also modules for Guided Buying, Supplier Relationship Management etc. I was also tasked with maintaining and optimising the company's WordPress site. Technologies used include: HTML5, CSS/CSS3, SASS, JavaScript, jQuery, React, GraphQL, Angular, Node JS, GraphQL, Gulp, Bower, Yarn, Bootstrap 4, FontAwesome 5 Pro, Caché Server Pages

London Borough of Waltham Forest - <https://walthamstowwetlands.com>, <https://wfculture19.co.uk>

June 2017 – July 2019: Lead Front End Developer and UI /UX Architect/Designer; I was engaged to be the senior Front-End, UX/UI Developer to a small team, who were tasked with creating several websites for the Local Authorities departments, were commercialising their services to the general public. We produced approx. 15 websites in just over 2 years, including; the sites above and more. My main roles on these sites were to produce compact, flexible, modular mark-up and styling, for inclusion into the Drupal CMS templates Technologies used were: HTML5, CSS3 Bootstrap 3&4, SASS, FontAwesome3/4, jQuery, React, Angular, Node JS, Gulp, Bower, Yarn, CMS; Drupal 7 & 8

London Borough of Croydon - <https://my.croydon.gov.uk>

May 2016 – May 2017: Lead Front End/UI and UX Architect/Designer; My role on this project was to Introduce and set up new technologies and methods of working to the front end stack, and to implement new page designs. I was also tasked with updating the markup to HTML5, adding new features and designing new functionality, to improve the user experience. We were working in an Agile environment in this large local authority. The technologies used in this project were: .NET, MVC 4, TFS, Razor view engine, HTML5, Bootstrap 3, LESS, FontAwesome3/4, jQuery, React, Angular JS, Node JS, Gulp, Bower

Cognifide - <http://cognifide.com>

July 2015 – March 2016: Senior User Interface Developer; I was engaged by this large consultancy to work as part of their teams, developing new user interfaces for two of their blue-chip clients **The Telegraph** and **Ford**; these roles included working in agile environments, producing new pages, features and functionality, as part of the re-launch/re-brand of these major web sites/applications. The skills and technologies used on these projects were: – HTML5, CSS/CSS3, AEM (Adobe Experience Manager), Responsive Design/Media Queries, Object Orientated JavaScript, jQuery, Angular, SASS, FontAwesome, Icomoon, Grunt (Ford), Gulp (Telegraph), Foundation.

Bid on This - <http://bidonthis.co.uk>

Jan 2015 – May 2015: Lead User Interface Developer, Scrum Master. This start-up online auction site engaged me as a senior front-end developer. My duties included producing new adaptive layouts and styling the main pages of the site including all user interactions, I was also asked to use my design/UX knowledge to introduce a consistent look and feel between the web application and the WordPress CMS, and Production of a Style Guide. Also, I was tasked with acting as scrum master on the project, mentoring and assisting the business team to introduce agile techniques. – HTML5, CSS/CSS3, Responsive Design/Media Queries, Object Orientated JavaScript, Angular, SASS, Compass, FontAwesome, Grunt, Bower, Jasmine, Twitter Bootstrap3 WordPress.

Market.com/Camden Market - <http://www.market.com> <http://www.everything5pounds.com>

Sept 2014 – Dec 2014: Lead User Interface Developer. I was contacted by Born Group to act as the senior front-end developer, on this project for the owners of Camden Market. The task was to re-skin and put a new Hybris back end onto their existing c-commerce site <http://www.everything5pounds.com> and to create a new and responsive sister site that used the same catalogue <http://www.market.com>. – HTML5, CSS/CSS3, Responsive Design/Media Queries, Object Orientated JavaScript, jQuery, Hybris, JSP.

Hotels4u/Thomas Cook - <http://www.hotels4u.com>

Mar 2014 – Sept 2014: Lead User Interface Developer. I was engaged by Hotels4u.com, which is part of the Thomas Cook Group, to produce the front-end/UI for their new responsive, hotel search and booking, eCommerce site. My responsibilities included producing all page layouts and styling, including media queries to enable the site to render correctly across a full range of devices, from mobiles in portrait mode, to large desktop displays, and also to enable the site to offer different functionality depending on display size and device. – HTML5, CSS/CSS3, Responsive Design/Media Queries, Object Orientated JavaScript, jQuery, Angular, AJAX, LESS, Grunt, Jasmine, Twitter Bootstrap3.

Pearson - <http://www.pearson.com>

Oct 2013 – Mar 2014: Lead Front End/UI and UX Architect/Designer; I was contacted by this global publishing company, primarily to build and style the user interface to an XML-based Global Content Authoring system. The system was built around the XOPUS XML editor and provided an interface that enabled authors to enter content to be stored in an XML schema that allowed it to be output to be in multiple formats. I also developed the front end of Pearson's CHORUS (Content Hub, Organise, Re-Use, and Share) Extranet application. – HTML5, CSS/CSS3, Responsive Design/ Media Queries, Object Orientated JavaScript, jQuery, Underscore, AJAX, SASS, Twitter Bootstrap, XML, XSLT, XOPUS.

Sportlabs Technology - <http://www.sportlabs.com>

Jan 2013– September 2013: Lead User Interface Developer/ Agile Coach /Project Manager.
Because of my wide range of experience, I was contacted by this small start-up company, which specialises in sports-related sites and mobile applications, to provide support in a variety of areas. My primary function was to help develop the website of a tournament planning application for the Lawn Tennis Association, and also some work on the UEFA website for the Respect Campaign. – HTML5, CSS3, Responsive Design/ Media Queries, Object Orientated JavaScript, jQuery, Knockout, Underscore, Parse, AJAX, Umbraco, Agile.

HH Global

Nov 2011– Dec 2012: Senior Interface/User Experience Developer- Agile Coach.

I was engaged by this global print management house primarily to produce the UI and to recommend best practices from a User Experience perspective to a Print Management application, and secondly, due to my agile experience to assist the project manager and offer guidance in adopting Agile/Scrum procedures. - XHTML/HTML5, CSS/CSS3, Object Orientated JavaScript, jQuery, AJAX, Agile.

ASOS

Sept 2011 – Nov 2011: Senior Interface Developer.

This was a short-term contract for this leading online fashion house. I was tasked with producing their online lookbook that is available to the trade and fashion press to show their upcoming collections, producing the front end and adding functionality to work cross-browser and cross-platform including Tablets. - XHTML/HTML5, CSS/CSS3, Responsive Design/ Media Queries, JavaScript, jQuery, AJAX.

BBC

Oct 2010 – Sept 2011: Lead Client-Side Developer/Technical Consultant.

I was working for the BBC's FM&T (Future Media & Technology) division, specifically working on the My Web My Way site www.bbc.co.uk/accessability, among my responsibilities was to add functionality to the site, in particular;

1. Object Orientated JavaScript modifies the DOM and therefore the user experience, according to choices of disability type, operating system and browser, made by the user.
2. Converting legacy JavaScript that switches stylesheets and text size according to the user's choices, from the BBC's Glow JavaScript library to jQuery.
3. The addition of JavaScript client-side search functionality.
5. The addition of social media sharing tools.

The main skills/techniques used on this contract were. – Object Orientated JavaScript, JSON, jQuery, AJAX, CSS, XHTML.

Employment: EMC Consulting/Conchango

Aug 2004 – April 2010 Technical Consultant/ Interface Developer

I was working as a Senior Technical Consultant, working on many prestigious projects for some blue-chip companies. When I started at Conchango I was 1 of only 2 permanent front-end/interface developers and as such worked on many and varied projects, from large internet sites to intranet sites and specialised web applications, I will list some of the larger or more interesting projects I worked on during this time, in chronological order, giving a brief description of the project my role on it and the technologies used.

Barclays – 2010: This project was to create a new personal banking portal for this large high-street bank. Working within a team based at Barclays offices near Canary Warf we were tasked with creating an interface with rich interactions. - XHTML, CSS, JavaScript, MVC, jQuery, AJAX.

Johnston Press – 2010: The brief on this project was to produce modular page layouts that could be branded for the various Johnston Press Titles and to provide a user interface to the Atex production system that was being rolled out across their publications. Also, write the necessary JavaScript to provide the rich interactions required. - XHTML, CSS, JavaScript, jQuery.

Aviva – 2009: I was tasked together with a Flash Developer with the production of a CD/DVD-based interactive Demo that could showcase the various Aviva products to their financial advisers. - XHTML, CSS, JavaScript, jQuery.

Moneysupermarket.com – 2009: I worked with a team of developers to provide the CSS XHTML expertise to style this SharePoint based Online insurance application form and provide JavaScript interactivity. - XHTML, CSS, JavaScript, jQuery, AJAX.

Associated news – 2009: Based within the Associated News Offices in Kensington, I produced modular mark-up, CSS and JavaScript functionality, to enable the Java developers to create this heavily form-based Intranet application to manage the advertising for the Daily Mail and Mail on Sunday. - XHTML, CSS, JavaScript, jQuery.

Visa - 2008 – 2009 This project was to produce a POC for a new interactive secure payment gateway for Visa that would allow the user to choose what card or method they wished to use. - XHTML, CSS, jQuery, XML, XSLT, AJAX.

River Island – 2008: I was one of the teams producing this large e-commerce site for this clothing retailer. I was tasked with creating page layouts, styling and interactions required by the designers and UE architects. This project followed the work done on Harrods.com. - XHTML, CSS, JavaScript, jQuery.

Vodafone – 2008: We were a small team, tasked with producing prototypes and practical examples of mark-up, styling and interactions, against this company's new Style Guide of its e-Services division, before its rollout across the whole of Europe. - XHTML, CSS, JavaScript, jQuery.

Harrods.com – 2007: On this project, I led a team of front-end developers in producing four interfaces on the same back-end of the e-commerce website, a call centre application to work in parallel with the website, a wedding list application and a content management system for this large prestigious retailer. Conchango produced a codebase from this project which is named DCP (Digital Commerce Platform) that was based on ASP.NET and Microsoft Commerce Server. - XHTML, CSS, JavaScript, jQuery.

HiFX - 2006 – 2007: This project-based in Windsor for this global foreign exchange company, was to produce page layouts and styling plus functionality around the Sitecore content management system for all their sites globally. - XHTML, CSS, JavaScript, CMS.

Virginmobile.com – 2006: I was one of two front-end developers working in a large team, tasked with providing page layout styling for the launch of this large website for this mobile phone operator. - XHTML, CSS, JavaScript.

Lloyds.com – 2005: I was the lead UI developer on this project which was based in the Lloyds building in London; this project involved the re-branding and production of page layouts, style sheets and functionality for the launch of the website for this large insurance organisation. - XHTML, CSS, JavaScript.